GRADE 7 ELA

Literature and Reading Comprehension

150 Multiple-Choice Questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Common Core-aligned practice with original fiction, folktale-style narratives, poetry, and literary analysis.

Skills assessed: textual evidence, inference, theme, character development, plot and conflict, point of view, figurative language, tone and mood, symbolism, structure, and author's craft.

Student instructions: Read each passage carefully. Choose the best answer for each question. Use evidence and reasoning to determine the strongest answer.

Easy Questions

The Last Seat

Mara arrived at the library ten minutes before closing. Every table was occupied except one, where a backpack rested on the chair. She looked around for its owner, but the room was quiet. A librarian explained that a student had stepped out to return a book. Mara could have moved the bag, yet she chose to wait. When the student returned, he thanked her and offered to share the table. Mara opened her notebook and began the science report she had nearly postponed.

1. Why did Mara hesitate to use the empty chair?

A. A student’s backpack was on it

B. She had forgotten her notebook

C. The table was too small

D. The librarian told her to leave

2. Which trait best describes Mara?

A. Impatient

B. Careless

C. Competitive

D. Considerate

3. What does “postponed” most nearly mean in the passage?

A. Started early

B. Explained aloud

C. Finished quickly

D. Put off until later

4. What can the reader infer about the student who returned?

A. He wanted the library to close

B. He had lost his science report

C. He planned to move the table

D. He appreciated Mara’s choice

5. Which event happens last?

A. Mara arrives at the library

B. Mara begins her report

C. The student returns

D. The librarian explains the situation

A Kite in the Wind

The kite rose above the park, its red tail snapping in the wind. Niko held the string tightly while his sister Lena ran across the grass. Suddenly, the kite dipped toward a tree. Niko loosened the string, then pulled gently when the wind shifted. The kite lifted free and climbed again. Lena stopped running and watched it glide. “You didn’t fight the wind,” she said. Niko smiled. “I tried to work with it.”

6. What problem does Niko face?

A. The wind stops completely

B. The kite dips toward a tree

C. Lena loses the string

D. The kite’s tail breaks

7. How does Niko help the kite rise again?

A. He climbs the tree

B. He works with changing wind

C. He cuts the string

D. He asks Lena to pull harder

8. What does Lena’s comment suggest?

A. She wants to go home

B. She dislikes flying kites

C. She notices Niko’s skill

D. She thinks the kite is broken

9. Which word best describes the wind in the passage?

A. Gentle throughout

B. Unchanging

C. Absent

D. Shifting

10. What is a likely lesson of the passage?

A. Success can require adapting

B. Winning always takes strength

C. Nature can always be controlled

D. Practice makes tools unnecessary

The Empty Birdhouse

For weeks, Amari checked the birdhouse he had built with his grandfather. No birds came. He wondered whether the entrance was too small or the paint too bright. His grandfather suggested waiting through the season. In early spring, Amari heard a soft tapping near the porch. A pair of wrens carried grass into the birdhouse. He watched from the window instead of rushing outside. By afternoon, the birds had disappeared inside, leaving only a few strands of grass near the entrance.

11. What had Amari been waiting for?

A. A new set of tools

B. Rain to stop

C. Birds to use the birdhouse

D. His grandfather to paint the porch

12. Why does Amari watch from the window?

A. He does not want to disturb the birds

B. He cannot find his shoes

C. His grandfather orders him inside

D. The porch is being repaired

13. What does “wrens” refer to?

A. A building tool

B. A season

C. A kind of grass

D. A type of bird

14. How does Amari most likely feel at the end?

A. Angry

B. Disappointed

C. Proud and pleased

D. Confused about the season

15. Which detail shows that the birds are using the birdhouse?

A. Amari checks it for weeks

B. The paint is bright

C. They carry grass inside

D. His grandfather suggests waiting

The Team Poster

The seventh-grade robotics team needed a poster for the school fair. Jo wanted a large drawing of a robot, while Priya wanted the poster to explain how their machine sorted objects. They argued until Mateo suggested a split design: a bold picture at the top and a clear diagram below. The team tried it. Students who passed the booth stopped to look at the robot, then stayed to ask how the sorting system worked. Jo admitted that the diagram made the picture more interesting.

16. What disagreement does the team have?

A. Who should leave the team

B. What the poster should emphasize

C. Whether to build a robot

D. Where to hold the fair

17. How does Mateo solve the problem?

A. He removes the diagram

B. He combines both suggestions

C. He asks the teacher to decide

D. He chooses Jo’s idea only

18. What is the result of the new poster?

A. The team cancels the fair

B. The robot stops working

C. Students ignore the booth

D. Students ask about the machine

19. Which theme is best supported?

A. Simple projects attract no attention

B. Different ideas can strengthen a project

C. Arguments should never happen

D. Art is always better than science

20. What does Jo’s final comment reveal?

A. Jo thinks the diagram is inaccurate

B. Jo has reconsidered the design

C. Jo wants a different robot

D. Jo refuses to help again

Grandmother’s Recipe

Every winter, Grandmother made orange bread from a recipe written on a faded card. This year, Eli offered to help. He measured the flour carefully but poured in twice the amount of orange zest. Grandmother tasted the dough and raised an eyebrow. Eli expected her to scold him, but she laughed and said they could add more flour and milk to balance the flavor. The loaf came out sharper than usual, yet everyone asked for a second slice.

21. What mistake does Eli make?

A. He burns the loaf

B. He forgets the flour

C. He adds too much orange zest

D. He uses salt instead of milk

22. How does Grandmother respond to the mistake?

A. She blames Eli and leaves

B. She refuses to bake again

C. She calmly finds a solution

D. She throws the recipe away

23. What does “faded” suggest about the recipe card?

A. It is old and worn

B. It is newly printed

C. It is very large

D. It is difficult to fold

24. Why is the bread different this year?

A. Grandmother forgets the recipe

B. The family buys a new loaf

C. The oven is broken

D. Eli changes the amount of zest

25. What can be inferred from the family’s reaction?

A. They dislike orange bread

B. They enjoy the unusual flavor

C. They do not notice the mistake

D. They want Eli to stop cooking

The Crossing Guard

Each morning, Mr. Bell stood at the corner near the school. He raised his stop sign, waited for cars to halt, and waved children across. One rainy day, a driver rolled through the crossing without slowing. Mr. Bell stepped back and held up his hand until the car stopped. He then waited for the road to clear completely before guiding the children across. Afterward, he reminded them that arriving a minute late was better than crossing unsafely.

26. What is Mr. Bell's main responsibility?

A. Repairing cars near the school

B. Cleaning the street

C. Teaching children to drive

D. Keeping children safe as they cross

27. Why does Mr. Bell wait after the car stops?

A. He is waiting for the rain to end

B. He wants the driver to leave town

C. He has misplaced his sign

D. He wants the road to be fully clear

28. Which trait best describes Mr. Bell?

A. Careful

B. Shy

C. Forgetful

D. Reckless

29. What message does Mr. Bell give the children?

A. Rain makes crossing impossible

B. Drivers always follow rules

C. Speed matters more than safety

D. Safety is worth a small delay

30. Which detail best supports the idea that Mr. Bell is alert?

A. He notices and responds to the moving car

B. It is raining

C. He stands at the corner each morning

D. He reminds children about lateness

A Poem for the Moon

The moon hangs over roofs of gray,
A silver coin that will not stay.
It follows me along the street,
Then hides where clouds and shadows meet.
I know it does not chase my feet,
Yet every step makes night feel sweet.

31. What is the moon compared to in line two?

A. A winter tree

B. A silver coin

C. A bright window

D. A paper boat

32. Which mood does the poem mainly create?

A. Panic

B. Boredom

C. Calm wonder

D. Anger

33. What does the speaker recognize in the final lines?

A. The moon has fallen to the street

B. The moon's movement only seems personal

C. The clouds have disappeared

D. The moon is literally following them

34. Which pair of words rhyme?

A. street / clouds

B. gray / stay

C. roofs / coin

D. moon / shadows

35. What is the poem mostly about?

A. A journey to another planet

B. A child afraid of the dark

C. The speaker's imaginative experience of the moon

D. A storm destroying a town

The Borrowed Book

Tessa borrowed a mystery novel from her classmate Omar. She promised to return it on Friday, but she finished reading it late Thursday night and left it under a blanket. On Friday morning, she nearly forgot it. Then she saw Omar searching his bag for another book to read during lunch. Tessa hurried home after school, found the novel, and returned it the next morning with an apology. Omar thanked her for being honest.

36. Why does Tessa nearly forget the book?

A. She leaves it under a blanket

B. The book is at the library

C. Omar asks her to keep it

D. She has not finished reading it

37. What causes Tessa to remember her promise?

A. Her teacher gives a quiz

B. Omar sends a letter

C. She loses her own notebook

D. She sees Omar looking for a book

38. How does Tessa respond after realizing her mistake?

A. She buys a different book

B. She blames Omar

C. She hides the book

D. She returns it and apologizes

39. What does Omar's reaction suggest?

A. He values Tessa’s honesty

B. He does not want the book back

C. He plans to stop reading

D. He is angry forever

40. Which event occurs first?

A. Omar searches his bag

B. Tessa returns the book

C. Tessa apologizes

D. Tessa borrows the novel

The Small Garden

Behind the apartment building, residents had a narrow strip of soil that collected litter. Mrs. Chen proposed planting herbs there. At first, only three neighbors joined her. They cleared the rubbish, loosened the soil, and planted mint and basil in recycled containers. A month later, more residents began watering the plants. Soon the garden supplied fresh herbs for several families and gave neighbors a reason to talk to one another.

41. What was the area like before the project?

A. It held a playground

B. It was already full of herbs

C. It collected litter

D. It was crowded with trees

42. What first motivates the neighbors to work together?

A. A broken water pipe

B. A school assignment

C. Mrs. Chen’s proposal

D. A contest with another building

43. What happens after a month?

A. The building is sold

B. More residents help care for it

C. The garden is removed

D. The herbs stop growing

44. Which theme is best supported?

A. Gardening requires expensive equipment

B. Small community efforts can grow

C. Only experts can improve a place

D. Neighbors should avoid one another

45. What is one benefit beyond growing food?

A. Neighbors begin connecting socially

B. Residents no longer need water

C. The garden makes the building taller

D. The litter increases

The Missed Note

Before the school concert, Daniel was sure he knew every note in his solo. During rehearsal, he missed a high note and stopped singing. The music teacher asked him to continue even after a mistake. Daniel practiced the difficult measure slowly, then gradually increased the speed. On concert night, he missed the note again but kept singing. The audience applauded, and Daniel felt more proud of finishing than he would have felt from a perfect performance.

46. What does Daniel do after missing the note in rehearsal?

A. He changes instruments

B. He quits the concert

C. He keeps practicing the difficult measure

D. He asks the audience to leave

47. What advice does the teacher give?

A. Avoid practicing slowly

B. Choose an easier song immediately

C. Continue even after an error

D. Stop whenever a mistake happens

48. Why is Daniel proud at the end?

A. He sings louder than everyone

B. He receives a new instrument

C. He finishes despite making a mistake

D. He performs without any errors

49. Which theme is developed?

A. Mistakes should be hidden

B. Perseverance matters more than perfection

C. Audiences dislike effort

D. Music is only for professionals

50. What does “gradually” mean as used in the passage?

A. Little by little

B. Without care

C. By accident

D. All at once

Medium Questions

The Mapmaker’s Apprentice

When the town council asked for a map of the old canal paths, apprentice mapmaker Sela volunteered. Her mentor warned that the oldest maps disagreed about where the canal bent near the mill. Sela visited the site, measured the remaining stone edges, and interviewed two residents whose families had lived there for generations. Their memories conflicted, but the stones showed a sharper turn than either person recalled. Sela marked the bend with a dotted line and added a note explaining the uncertainty. The council praised the map because it showed not only what was known but also what remained unclear.

51. Why does Sela use several sources of information?

A. The council forbids measuring the site

B. The old maps and memories do not fully agree

C. Her mentor refuses to help her

D. The canal has recently been rebuilt

52. What does the dotted line most likely communicate?

A. An area where the evidence is uncertain

B. A path that should be ignored

C. A canal that is still full of water

D. A route that is completely certain

53. Which quality best describes Sela’s approach?

A. She hides conflicting evidence

B. She chooses the oldest account automatically

C. She records uncertainty honestly

D. She guesses to finish quickly

54. How do the stone edges affect Sela’s conclusion?

A. They prove both residents were lying

B. They make all the maps useless

C. They show the canal never reached the mill

D. They support a sharper bend than the residents remember

55. What broader idea does the council’s praise support?

A. A useful account can distinguish facts from uncertainties

B. Memory is always more reliable than physical evidence

C. A map should never include notes

D. Disagreement makes research impossible

The Debate Team

Ravi joined the debate team because he enjoyed finding facts. At his first competition, he presented a long list of statistics but barely addressed the opposing speaker’s argument. His coach asked him to summarize the other side fairly before responding. Ravi thought this would waste time. During the next debate, however, he discovered that accurately stating the opposing view helped him identify its weakest assumption. His response became shorter, clearer, and more persuasive.

56. What is Ravi’s initial weakness as a debater?

A. He agrees with every opposing claim

B. He speaks too quietly to be heard

C. He relies on facts without addressing the opposing argument

D. He refuses to use evidence

57. Why does the coach ask Ravi to summarize the other side?

A. To ensure the debate lasts longer

B. To prevent him from using statistics

C. To help him respond directly and fairly

D. To make him abandon his own position

58. What does Ravi learn about fair summary?

A. It guarantees that opponents agree

B. It can reveal weaknesses in an argument

C. It makes evidence unnecessary

D. It prevents a speaker from being persuasive

59. Which statement best describes the change in Ravi?

A. He stops preparing for competitions

B. He replaces evidence with jokes

C. He becomes less interested in debate

D. He moves from listing information to reasoning against a claim

60. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Short speeches always win competitions

B. Strong argument requires engaging with opposing reasoning

C. Debaters should avoid listening to others

D. Statistics are never useful in debates

The Window Seat

On the train, Mina always chose the window seat and watched the city pass. Her brother Theo preferred the aisle because he liked to stand and stretch. One afternoon, a woman boarded carrying a large box and paused beside their row. Mina moved her bag from the empty window seat, but Theo rose and offered his aisle seat instead, where the woman could settle without lifting the box over anyone. Mina realized that she had thought only about making space, while Theo had considered what the passenger needed.

61. What contrast between Mina and Theo is emphasized?

A. Mina carries a box while Theo carries a bag

B. Mina makes room, while Theo considers the passenger’s practical needs

C. Mina refuses to share, while Theo leaves the train

D. Mina notices scenery while Theo dislikes trains

62. Why is the aisle seat more helpful to the woman?

A. It lets her sit without lifting the box over others

B. It is closer to the window

C. It is reserved for passengers with boxes

D. It gives her more time to buy a ticket

63. What does Mina's realization suggest?

A. Window seats are always selfish choices

B. Theo is always correct

C. Kindness can involve anticipating another person's needs

D. Passengers should travel alone

64. Which point of view is used?

A. Third person that follows Mina's observations

B. Second person giving instructions

C. First person told by Mina

D. A narrator who knows every passenger's thoughts

65. Which detail best develops Theo's characterization?

A. He likes to stand and stretch

B. He offers his aisle seat to make the passenger's movement easier

C. He boards the train in the afternoon

D. He prefers the aisle

The Clockmaker's Window

Every evening, Mr. Vale turned the sign on his shop door to CLOSED, yet the light behind his workbench remained on. People assumed he was repairing clocks for wealthy customers. In truth, he was restoring the town hall clock, whose hands had stopped during a storm years earlier. He refused payment because, he said, the clock belonged to everyone. When it rang again on the first day of spring, people gathered in the square. Mr. Vale watched from his window, pleased that the sound had returned to the town's shared life.

66. Why do people misunderstand Mr. Vale's late work?

A. They assume he serves wealthy customers

B. They hear him complain about the town

C. They know he is repairing the town hall clock

D. They see him close the shop early

67. What does the town hall clock symbolize in the passage?

A. The end of craftsmanship

B. Private wealth

C. A shared community identity

D. The danger of storms

68. Why does Mr. Vale refuse payment?

A. The town refuses to pay him

B. He believes the clock belongs to everyone

C. He has no tools left

D. He wants to close the shop permanently

69. What is the effect of revealing Mr. Vale's true purpose late in the passage?

A. It changes the reader's understanding of his actions

B. It explains how storms form

C. It creates a new conflict with a customer

D. It proves the townspeople are clockmakers

70. Which theme is best supported?

A. Public service can be motivated by shared pride rather than reward

B. Old objects have no value

C. People should never work after hours

D. Success depends on being wealthy

The Orchard in Winter

In November, the orchard looked lifeless. The branches were bare, the grass had browned, and the last apples lay in a crate beside the shed. Nia asked her father why he did not cut down the trees and plant something more useful. He showed her the small buds tucked against the branches. They were hard and closed, but each held the beginning of a leaf or flower. “The orchard is resting,” he said. Nia returned in March and found green points pushing through the bark.

71. What does Nia misunderstand at the beginning?

A. She believes apples grow only in winter

B. She thinks the shed is too small

C. She assumes her father dislikes gardening

D. She thinks the orchard’s bare appearance means it has no future growth

72. What do the buds represent?

A. The father’s uncertainty about farming

B. Hidden potential and renewal

C. The end of the orchard

D. A threat to the trees

73. How does the setting contribute to the passage?

A. The orchard creates a frightening atmosphere

B. The weather explains why Nia leaves home

C. Winter’s barrenness contrasts with spring’s new growth

D. The shed is the main source of conflict

74. What does Nia’s return in March suggest?

A. She has forgotten the orchard entirely

B. She wants to test her father’s explanation

C. She dislikes seeing new growth

D. She plans to cut down the trees

75. Which statement best expresses a theme?

A. An apparent pause can hide the beginnings of change

B. Nature follows human schedules

C. Old trees should be replaced quickly

D. Useful things must always look attractive

The Unsent Letter

After an argument with her friend, Leila wrote a letter listing every unfair thing that had happened between them. She planned to leave it in her friend's locker. Before school, she read it again and noticed that every sentence began with "you." She rewrote the letter, explaining how she had felt and asking what her friend had meant. The second letter was shorter. Her friend read it, then asked to talk after class. They did not solve everything that day, but they began listening instead of preparing replies.

76. What does the repeated use of "you" in Leila's first letter reveal?

A. The letter is a poem

B. Leila has no concerns

C. The letter focuses on blame

D. The friend wrote the letter

77. Why does Leila revise the letter?

A. She wants to make the letter longer

B. She decides to explain her feelings and invite dialogue

C. She wants to avoid speaking forever

D. She learns that writing is forbidden

78. What does the final sentence imply about listening?

A. It prevents people from having disagreements

B. It guarantees immediate agreement

C. It is less useful than preparing a reply

D. It can begin repairing a conflict even before it is solved

79. Which plot event marks the turning point?

A. Leila notices the repeated "you" and rewrites the letter

B. The friend enters the classroom

C. Leila has an argument

D. The school day begins

80. Which theme is best supported?

A. Apologies require one person to accept all blame

B. Written messages always solve conflicts

C. Friends should never disagree

D. Communication improves when people move from accusation to curiosity

A Narrow Bridge

The footbridge over the creek had one loose plank. Most walkers stepped around it, and the town had placed a warning sign at either end. When heavy rain washed away part of the bank, the bridge became the only direct route to the clinic. Some residents argued that it should be closed; others said people needed access. The town engineer inspected the supports and arranged a temporary walkway on firmer ground. The bridge remained closed until repairs were complete, but the clinic also organized rides for residents who needed them.

81. What conflict does the town face?

A. Finding a new creek

B. Choosing which clinic to build

C. Deciding whether rain is useful

D. Balancing safe travel with access to the clinic

82. Why is the engineer's inspection important?

A. It replaces the need for repairs

B. It proves the bridge is perfectly safe

C. It prevents residents from reaching the clinic

D. It helps determine a safer temporary solution

83. What does the town's response show?

A. Residents' needs do not matter

B. Safety and access can both be considered in a solution

C. Rules should be ignored during emergencies

D. Temporary routes are always dangerous

84. Which detail creates the central urgency?

A. Walkers step around the loose plank

B. Heavy rain damages the bank and the bridge is a direct route to the clinic

C. The warning sign is at both ends

D. The engineer works for the town

85. How is the conflict resolved?

A. Residents repair the bridge without inspection

B. The clinic moves to another town

C. The town closes the bridge and arranges rides while repairs proceed

D. The bridge is declared safe without repairs

The Photograph

At the history exhibition, Sam displayed a photograph of a crowded street from fifty years earlier. The caption named the shops but said nothing about the people waiting outside a factory gate. His grandmother recognized the street and explained that the workers had gathered to demand safer conditions. Sam added a second caption, carefully distinguishing what the photograph showed from what his grandmother remembered. Visitors began asking why the original caption had omitted the workers' purpose.

86. What important information is missing from the original caption?

A. The reason workers gathered outside the factory

B. The location of the street

C. The age of the photograph

D. The names of the shops

87. Why does Sam distinguish what the photograph shows from what his grandmother remembers?

A. To suggest that his grandmother cannot remember anything

B. To separate visible evidence from personal recollection

C. To make the caption more confusing

D. To remove all interpretation from history

88. What effect does the revised caption have?

A. It makes the photograph less useful

B. It proves the shops were closed

C. It encourages visitors to question the original account

D. It stops visitors from asking questions

89. Which idea is most strongly developed?

A. Memories are more reliable than every document

B. Photographs always tell the full story

C. Historical accounts can shape what people notice or overlook

D. Captions should only name buildings

90. What is Sam's approach to the new caption?

A. He removes the workers from the display

B. He presents the family memory as the only possible truth

C. He changes the photograph itself

D. He adds context while marking the source of that context

The Glass Violin

A violinist named Anika was invited to play at a museum opening. The museum's newest exhibit contained delicate glass sculptures, and the curator asked her to play softly. Anika worried that a quiet performance would seem unimportant. During the opening, she chose a slow melody with long pauses. Visitors stopped speaking to hear the notes linger in the room. Afterward, the curator said the music had made people notice the fragile shapes and spaces between the sculptures.

91. Why is Anika initially concerned?

A. She thinks a quiet performance may seem unimportant

B. She wants the exhibit closed

C. She dislikes the museum's sculptures

D. She cannot play slow melodies

92. How does the music affect visitors?

A. It covers the sculptures with sound

B. It makes the room feel crowded

C. It makes them leave immediately

D. It encourages them to notice the exhibit more closely

93. What does "linger" most nearly mean in context?

A. Become louder

B. Break apart

C. Disappear instantly

D. Remain for a time

94. How does the setting influence Anika's artistic choice?

A. The room has no space for music

B. The museum requires her to play a fast song

C. The delicate sculptures lead her to choose a restrained melody

D. The visitors demand a louder performance

95. Which theme is best supported?

A. Art forms cannot influence one another

B. Museums should avoid live music

C. Loud performances are always more memorable

D. Subtle choices can have a powerful effect

Two Versions of a Race

The school newspaper published two accounts of the same relay race. The first reporter emphasized the winning team's final sprint and described the finish as inevitable. The second interviewed runners from both teams and learned that one runner had slowed to help a teammate who had stumbled. That moment did not change the official result, but it changed how several students discussed the race. The editor kept both reports and added a note explaining that each account selected different details.

96. How do the two reports differ?

A. Both use exactly the same details

B. One reports the result and the other changes it

C. One focuses on the finish, while the other includes a less visible act of sportsmanship

D. One describes a swimming race and the other a relay

97. What does "inevitable" suggest in the first account?

A. The outcome seemed certain

B. The race was canceled

C. The runners were confused

D. The finish was delayed

98. Why does the editor keep both reports?

A. They show how different choices of detail shape an account

B. They contain no useful information

C. They make the official result unclear

D. They disagree about which sport was played

99. What does the second account add to readers' understanding?

A. Evidence that the race never happened

B. A different official score

C. Proof that the winner cheated

D. A perspective on sportsmanship beyond the final result

100. Which statement best captures the passage's central idea?

A. A factual event can be presented through different emphases

B. The final result is never important

C. Reporters should avoid interviewing people

D. Only winning teams deserve coverage

Hard Questions

The Archive of Rain

The village archive kept rainfall records in three forms: a handwritten ledger, a set of instrument readings, and oral accounts from farmers. For the year of the great flood, the ledger recorded unusually heavy rain, while one instrument sheet showed a gap of eleven days. Several farmers remembered a long dry spell before the flood. The archivist, Imani, resisted the temptation to label any source false. She found that the instrument had been moved during repairs, and the missing readings came from the period when it was being recalibrated. The farmers' memories referred to the weeks before the storm, not the storm itself. Imani's final report preserved the disagreement and explained how each source measured a different part of the event.

101. Why does Imani avoid immediately labeling a source false?

A. She wants to hide the flood from the village

B. The ledger contains no dates

C. She believes every source must be perfectly accurate

D. The sources may differ in scope or reliability rather than directly contradicting one another

102. What best explains the gap in the instrument readings?

A. The farmers removed the pages

B. The ledger was copied incorrectly

C. The flood destroyed the archive

D. The instrument was moved and recalibrated

103. How does the farmers' recollection relate to the other evidence?

A. It makes the instrument readings irrelevant

B. It describes an earlier period, so it does not necessarily conflict with the flood records

C. It shows the ledger was written years later

D. It proves that no rain fell during the flood

104. Which best describes Imani's method?

A. She removes evidence that does not agree

B. She chooses the source with the most dramatic language

C. She reconciles evidence by considering context and limitations

D. She averages every source without investigation

105. What is the most important implication of the final report?

A. Instrument readings cannot be used in historical research

B. A single source is always enough to explain an event

C. Oral histories should never be included in archives

D. Reliable historical interpretation often requires explaining why sources differ

The Perfect Translation

When Elian translated a poem from an older language, he first tried to preserve each word as closely as possible. The result was accurate in a narrow sense but sounded stiff, and the repeated rhythms of the original disappeared. A colleague suggested that he preserve the poem's emotional movement rather than its exact word order. Elian revised several lines, changing the images slightly while keeping their relationships intact. Some scholars praised the new version; others argued that any altered image betrayed the original. Elian added a translator's note explaining his choices and the losses he could not

avoid.

106. What central tension drives the passage?

A. Whether a translation should prioritize literal wording or preserve the poem's effects

B. Whether the poem should be published at all

C. Whether scholars prefer poetry to prose

D. Whether Elian understands the older language

107. Why does Elian revise the lines?

A. The literal version loses rhythm and emotional force

B. The colleague asks him to shorten the poem by half

C. He discovers the poem was written in modern language

D. The original contains no images

108. What does the disagreement among scholars reveal?

A. Scholars have not read the original

B. One translation can preserve every feature perfectly

C. Translation involves interpretive choices that readers may value differently

D. Emotional meaning is irrelevant to poetry

109. What is the purpose of Elian's translator's note?

A. To replace the poem with a summary

B. To claim his version is unquestionably correct

C. To make his decisions and unavoidable losses transparent

D. To criticize readers who disagree

110. Which claim is best supported by the passage?

A. Faithful translation may require balancing competing kinds of accuracy

B. Word-for-word translation always produces the best poem

C. Readers should judge a translation only by its length

D. Changing any word makes translation impossible

The Mayor's Speech

The mayor opened the meeting by praising the town's new sports center as "a gift to every resident." The phrase drew applause, but the budget report showed that the center would be funded partly by reducing evening bus service in three neighborhoods. During questions, a student asked whether a gift remained a gift if some residents had to pay for it through lost access to transport. The mayor replied that the center would benefit the whole town over time. The student did not dispute the center's value; instead, she asked the council to publish an estimate of who would gain and who would bear the costs. The room grew quiet, and the council agreed to review the figures.

111. What is the main rhetorical effect of calling the center "a gift to every resident"?

A. It gives a precise account of the budget

B. It frames the project as universally beneficial before its costs are discussed

C. It identifies which neighborhoods pay most

D. It proves that bus service will improve

112. How does the student strengthen her challenge?

A. She refuses to ask for evidence

B. She repeats the mayor's phrase without analysis

C. She claims sports centers have no public value

D. She questions the distribution of costs without denying the center's possible value

113. What assumption in the mayor's reply does the student's question test?

A. That the center will never open

B. That every resident has the same schedule

C. That residents do not use buses

D. That long-term townwide benefits justify the immediate unequal burdens

114. Why does the room grow quiet?

A. The mayor announces a sports competition

B. The student forgets her question

C. The question exposes a consequential issue that the opening praise left unstated

D. The meeting is suddenly canceled

115. Which statement best characterizes the student's reasoning?

A. She asks for disaggregated evidence about benefits and burdens

B. She argues that all public spending is unfair

C. She relies entirely on emotion and avoids facts

D. She assumes the budget report is false

The House with Two Doors

In the village story, a traveler reaches a house with two doors. One bears a painted sun; the other, a painted moon. The host says that one door leads to shelter and the other to a maze, but refuses to say which is which. The traveler studies the paintings and chooses the moon door, reasoning that the moon guides people at night. Inside, she finds a maze—but notices that its walls are covered with maps. She follows them and discovers a passage to the shelter. Later tellers disagree: some say the traveler chose wrongly but learned to navigate; others say the maze was the only route to genuine shelter. The story never settles the question.

116. What makes the ending ambiguous?

A. The host explains the correct door at the end

B. The traveler reaches shelter through the maze, leaving unclear whether her choice was wrong or necessary

C. The paintings disappear before she chooses

D. The traveler never enters either door

117. What might the maps in the maze symbolize?

A. Knowledge that helps transform an obstacle into a path

B. A warning that shelter does not exist

C. Proof that the traveler cannot read

D. The host's desire to confuse every visitor

118. How do the different tellers affect the story's meaning?

A. They remove the traveler from the plot

B. They present competing interpretations without establishing one as final

C. They agree that the traveler is foolish

D. They explain the host's secret identity

119. Which interpretation is best supported but not conclusively proven?

A. Every difficult choice is a mistake

B. The moon always symbolizes danger

C. A difficult route can provide the knowledge needed to reach a goal

D. The host wants travelers to remain trapped

120. Why might the author leave the question unresolved?

A. To invite readers to evaluate how success and failure are defined

B. To make the traveler's actions irrelevant

C. To avoid including any meaningful conflict

D. To prove that maps are unreliable

The Quiet Inventor

Mara's invention reduced the noise made by the school's ventilation fans. At the science fair, judges asked how much energy it saved. Mara had measured sound levels carefully but had tested energy use only once, on a mild day. One judge praised the sound reduction; another warned that the energy claim was not yet supported. Mara felt her project had failed until her adviser pointed out that identifying the limits of a result was part of scientific work. Mara revised her display to separate the measured finding from the question still under investigation.

121. Why is the energy-saving claim weaker than the noise-reduction finding?

A. Mara measured energy use only once, under limited conditions

B. Mara did not measure sound levels

C. The judges refused to examine the invention

D. The fans were not part of the project

122. What does the second judge's response emphasize?

A. Claims should match the strength of the evidence

B. Every invention must save energy

C. A science fair should reward confidence over accuracy

D. Sound measurements are never useful

123. How does Mara's adviser reframe the apparent failure?

A. As a reason to remove all data

B. As an opportunity to identify what is known and what needs more testing

C. As proof that the invention should be abandoned

D. As evidence that the judges were unfair

124. Why does Mara revise the display?

A. To distinguish established results from an untested possibility

B. To hide the energy measurement

C. To replace the sound data with opinions

D. To make the project seem more successful than it is

125. Which broader principle does the passage illustrate?

A. An invention should be judged only by its presentation

B. A single test always proves a general claim

C. Intellectual honesty includes acknowledging the limits of evidence

D. A result is worthless unless every question is answered

The River's Name

On old maps, the river was labeled "Clearwater." Residents now call it "the Brown," because runoff has darkened it after storms. In a public hearing, a developer argued that the older name reflected the river's enduring identity and that temporary discoloration should not define it. A fisher replied that the new name recorded what residents had witnessed for years, not a single storm. A historian noted that names can preserve memory, express hope, or expose a change people would rather ignore. The hearing ended without a vote on the name, but the council commissioned a water-quality study.

126. What does the disagreement over the river's name represent?

A. A disagreement about fishing licenses

B. A dispute about where the river begins

C. A debate over how maps are printed

D. A conflict between preserving an older identity and acknowledging changed conditions

127. How does the developer use the word "temporary"?

A. To prove the river is permanently polluted

B. To argue that residents should stop fishing

C. To show that the old map is inaccurate in every way

D. To minimize the significance of the discoloration

128. What is the historian's contribution to the debate?

A. The historian proves the developer is correct

B. The historian broadens the issue by explaining the different meanings names can carry

C. The historian argues that names have no meaning

D. The historian chooses a new official name

129. Why is commissioning a water-quality study a meaningful ending?

A. It shifts part of the dispute from competing interpretations toward evidence

B. It makes the river's history irrelevant

C. It settles the name immediately

D. It proves the fisher invented the discoloration

130. Which statement best captures the passage's complexity?

A. Older names are always more truthful than newer ones

B. Scientific studies can determine what every symbol means

C. A name can preserve history while also concealing or revealing present realities

D. A river's name has no connection to community memory

The Unreliable Narrator

I have always told people that I saved the school play. The night the curtain jammed, I was the only one who stayed calm—or so I say. I remember pulling the rope, hearing a snap, and watching the curtain rise. What I leave out is that the stage manager had already found a spare cord, and that I tied it badly enough for the curtain to fall a second time. When I tell the

story now, I usually stop at the applause. I suppose a story can be true in its details and still mislead by where it chooses to end.

131. Which detail most clearly makes the narrator unreliable?

A. The narrator remembers that a curtain existed

B. The narrator mentions a stage manager

C. The narrator says the audience applauded

D. The narrator admits leaving out facts that change the impression of the event

132. What does the narrator mean by a story being “true in its details” but misleading?

A. A story must contain invented characters to be misleading

B. Individual facts can be accurate while selective omission distorts the overall account

C. Every memory is entirely false

D. A story is truthful only when it ends with applause

133. Why does the narrator usually stop at the applause?

A. The play ends before the curtain rises

B. That ending preserves a flattering version of the event

C. The audience leaves before the mistake

D. The narrator cannot remember the rest

134. What effect does the first-person point of view create?

A. Readers learn every character’s private thoughts

B. Readers receive an entirely neutral report

C. Readers cannot tell who is speaking

D. Readers can hear the narrator’s self-justification while noticing its limits

135. Which theme is best supported?

A. Audiences always know the whole truth

B. Omission can shape a story as powerfully as false statements

C. A person who stays calm never makes mistakes

D. Stories should end at the most exciting moment

The Orchard Contract

A town leased its unused orchard to a cooperative that promised free fruit for the school cafeteria. The contract required the cooperative to maintain every tree, but it did not specify how much fruit had to be delivered. After a dry summer, the cooperative delivered only a few crates, explaining that the harvest had been poor. Some council members called this a broken promise; others argued that the agreement had never guaranteed a quantity. The students’ representative proposed that the next contract include both a minimum delivery target and a clause allowing exceptions for severe weather. The council postponed its decision to consult an agricultural specialist.

136. What is the main source of the dispute?

A. The orchard has no trees

B. The cooperative was forbidden to maintain the orchard

C. The contract promises free fruit but does not specify a minimum quantity

D. The school refuses to accept fruit

137. Why do council members interpret the outcome differently?

A. They have different accounts of the weather forecast

B. They believe the orchard belongs to another town

C. They disagree about whether the school has students

D. They disagree about whether the broad promise implies a guaranteed amount

138. How does the student representative's proposal address both sides?

A. It sets a clear target while allowing for exceptional conditions

B. It cancels all maintenance duties

C. It removes the school from the agreement

D. It guarantees a harvest regardless of weather

139. Why consult an agricultural specialist?

A. To prove that the cooperative acted dishonestly

B. To replace the contract with a poem

C. To decide which council members should resign

D. To inform the contract with practical knowledge about harvest variability

140. Which lesson about agreements is best supported?

A. A promise should never include exceptions

B. Disputes prove that cooperation cannot work

C. Clear terms should define expectations and how unusual circumstances will be handled

D. Good intentions make written terms unnecessary

The Museum of Ordinary Things

The museum's curator proposed an exhibition of ordinary objects: a cracked mug, a bus ticket, a worn key, and a school lunchbox. One board member objected that visitors expected rare artifacts. The curator argued that ordinary objects could reveal how people lived, traveled, and cared for one another. To test the idea, she invited residents to submit short accounts of an object they had kept. A lunchbox arrived with a note from a parent who had packed meals during a long hospital stay; the worn key belonged to a tenant who had finally moved into a first apartment. The board approved the exhibition, though the curator kept the labels brief so visitors could form their own interpretations.

141. What assumption does the board member make?

A. Residents should not contribute objects

B. Museum value depends mainly on rarity

C. Visitors dislike written labels

D. Ordinary objects cannot have histories

142. How do the residents' accounts strengthen the curator's argument?

A. They eliminate the need for an exhibition

B. They make the objects rare

C. They prove the objects are expensive

D. They connect everyday objects to meaningful human experiences

143. Why does the curator keep the labels brief?

A. To leave room for visitors to interpret the objects themselves

B. To hide the objects' origins

C. To make visitors believe every object is ancient

D. To reduce the number of objects on display

144. Which contrast structures the passage?

A. The residents' desire to sell objects versus the museum's need to buy them

B. The difference between old and new museums

C. The board's focus on rarity versus the curator's focus on human meaning

D. The curator's interest in art versus her dislike of history

145. Which conclusion is best supported?

A. Ordinary objects have the same meaning to everyone

B. An object's significance may come from the life it represents rather than its rarity

C. Only objects with written notes belong in museums

D. Visitors cannot interpret objects without long labels

The Silence Between Lines

In the novel, the narrator never describes the argument between the two sisters. Instead, the chapter begins the next morning: one cup sits untouched, a door is shut, and a familiar chair has been moved to the far side of the room. The sisters speak politely about the weather. Readers learn later that the argument concerned whether their mother's letters should be published. Because the scene withholds the confrontation, the ordinary objects and careful dialogue carry the emotional weight. The omission also leaves readers to decide which sister's silence signals hurt, anger, or restraint.

146. What is the effect of omitting the argument itself?

A. It makes the narrator omniscient

B. It proves the sisters have forgotten their mother

C. It makes readers infer the conflict from objects and restrained dialogue

D. It removes the conflict from the novel entirely

147. How do the moved chair and untouched cup function?

A. They serve as indirect clues to the sisters' emotional distance

B. They are unrelated details included for realism

C. They explain exactly what each sister said

D. They prove that one sister has left the house

148. Why does the later revelation about the letters matter?

A. It gives context to the tension without changing the indirect style of the earlier scene

B. It shows that the objects were described inaccurately

C. It proves the sisters argued about the weather

D. It resolves every question about their feelings

149. What does the passage suggest about silence?

A. It always signals agreement

B. Its meaning depends on context and may remain open to interpretation

C. It can only mean anger

D. It is less expressive than direct explanation

150. Which authorial technique is most prominent?

A. A direct explanation of every character’s motive

B. A comic exaggeration of the sisters

C. Indirect characterization through setting and behavior

D. A chronological account of the argument

Answer Key

The key is listed in exact question-number order and matches the final option positions.

Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
1	A	51	B	101	D
2	D	52	A	102	D
3	D	53	C	103	B
4	D	54	D	104	C
5	B	55	A	105	D
6	B	56	C	106	A
7	B	57	C	107	A
8	C	58	B	108	C
9	D	59	D	109	C
10	A	60	B	110	A
11	C	61	B	111	B
12	A	62	A	112	D
13	D	63	C	113	D
14	C	64	A	114	C
15	C	65	B	115	A
16	B	66	A	116	B
17	B	67	C	117	A
18	D	68	B	118	B
19	B	69	A	119	C
20	B	70	A	120	A
21	C	71	D	121	A
22	C	72	B	122	A
23	A	73	C	123	B
24	D	74	B	124	A
25	B	75	A	125	C
26	D	76	C	126	D
27	D	77	B	127	D
28	A	78	D	128	B

Question	Answer	Question	Answer	Question	Answer
29	D	79	A	129	A
30	A	80	D	130	C
31	B	81	D	131	D
32	C	82	D	132	B
33	B	83	B	133	B
34	B	84	B	134	D
35	C	85	C	135	B
36	A	86	A	136	C
37	D	87	B	137	D
38	D	88	C	138	A
39	A	89	C	139	D
40	D	90	D	140	C
41	C	91	A	141	B
42	C	92	D	142	D
43	B	93	D	143	A
44	B	94	C	144	C
45	A	95	D	145	B
46	C	96	C	146	C
47	C	97	A	147	A
48	C	98	A	148	A
49	B	99	D	149	B
50	A	100	A	150	C

Correct-answer distribution: A = 38, B = 38, C = 37, D = 37.

Quality check: 150 questions; 50 per difficulty level; answer-key sequence 1–150 with no gaps or duplicates; every key entry matches the correct final option.